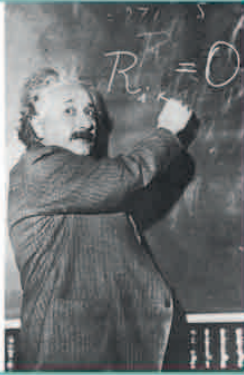


REAL WORLD

Eureka!

Albert Einstein is reputed to have uttered the interjection *Eureka!* on coming up with his special theory of relativity. *Eureka* is a Greek word, meaning “I have found it.” Similar moments of revelation may be marked by interjections like *aha!* or *hooray!*—the benefit being that a single-word interjection conveys much more emotion than a simple sentence.

**Greetings**

Everyday greetings like *hello*, *hi*, *goodbye*, and even *yoo-hoo* are interjections, functioning on their own or as part of a sentence. Like other interjections, if a greeting is removed from a sentence, the meaning of that sentence is not affected.

Hello, what are you doing?



This interjection is used to mean “be quiet!”

Shh! I’m concentrating.

**Interruptions and introductions**

Many English speakers use the interjections *er* or *um* to fill pauses in their speech, such as when they are unsure of what to say. These are sometimes called hesitation devices. *Yes*, *no*, and variations of the two are also interjections, as are other introductory expressions such as *indeed* and *well*. These can be used alone in response to a question or statement.

I, **er**, have no idea what has happened to, **um**, the snake charmer.

Commas are used on either side of a mild interjection such as a hesitation device if it appears in the middle of a sentence.

Yes, he’s been gone for ages. Where is he?

The interjections *yes* and *no* are used at the start of a sentence, followed by a comma, or on their own.

Asides

Interjections are often used in parentheses to indicate an aside or an action. This is particularly useful in a play script, because it indicates the tone of a sentence and gives directions to the actors.

The snake charmer is (**cough!**) temporarily unavailable.

This aside tells the speaker to pause and cough—in this case, indicating that the speaker doesn’t necessarily believe what he or she is saying.

